PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

OFFICE OF OPERATIONS

501 North Dixon Street / Portland, OR 97227
Telephone: (503) 916-2000
Mailing Address: P. O. Box 3107 / 97208-3107

Date: October 14, 2025

To: School Board

From: Jon Franco, Senior Chief of Operations

Subject: Adoption of Revised Jefferson HS Comprehensive Plan

BACKGROUND

Board Resolution 6153 referred the Jefferson High School Modernization project to voters as a part of the 2020 bond.

After the passage of the 2020 Bond, the Jefferson High School Modernization Project Team (Project Team) worked with internal stakeholders, external stakeholders, a community Comprehensive Planning Committee and the internal Jefferson Steering Committee to develop a Comprehensive Plan in conformance with the Comprehensive High School Education Specifications and Design Guidelines & Standards.

In December 2022, the PPS Board of Education approved the original Jefferson High School Comprehensive Plan as part of Resolution No. 6627, with a $366M total project cost, a capacity of approximately 1,700 students, and a program that included a 1,000-seat theater, dance studios, and a construction CTE program. That plan reflected PPS Facility Standards, the Climate Crisis Response Policy, and established a two-phase construction schedule with substantial completion in 2028.

In June 2023, Andersen Construction's first estimate of the project showed that a phased renovation, keeping students on site during construction, was adding over $150M to the project. Following a 3rd party VE workshop in July 2023, the Project Team proposed a new construction approach that would occur in a single phase in which students would swing off-site during construction.

In December 2023, the PPS Board of Education approved a change to that approach, where students would remain on campus during construction in the existing building, while a new building is constructed on the North end of the site. On April 2, 2023, the Board approved this project approach, with a $491M total project cost.

In December 2024, the three Project Teams were directed by District Leadership to pause designing and develop a series of cost reduction strategies for the JHS, CHS & IBW

modernizations, reducing project scope and costs. In February 2025, the Board passed Resolution No. 7051 to Adopt a Framework to Build High-Quality High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner. This resolution established a set of standards that the Project Teams utilized to develop their approach to the Cost Reduction Study. The Project Team worked to revise the design based on the revised scope, achieving a total project cost savings of $25M.

In Spring 2025, the Project Team was directed by District leadership to begin a new Schematic Design Phase based on the Cost Reduction Study.

Voters most recently passed the May 2025 Bond which provides the balance of necessary funding to complete the Jefferson High School Modernization project.

Finally, this Revised Jefferson HS Comprehensive Plan was first shared at the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee (FIOC) and that committee reviewed and recommended to forward it to the full Board at their September 16th meeting.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The PPS Comprehensive High School Educational Specifications, along with information on current Jefferson High School programming, was used as the basis for programming of the modernized Jefferson High School.

In addition to using these documents as the foundation for the Jefferson program, the Project Team conducted a rigorous outreach and engagement effort. The Project Team met with internal and external focus groups having over 600 stakeholder discussions and developed a Comprehensive Plan report for Jefferson that presents the specific room requirements and square footages, the interrelationships of spaces, and most importantly, represents the core educational values of PPS.

As part of the Jefferson High School Comprehensive Plan, the Project Team developed a detailed Area Program Summary that refines the PPS High School Ed Specs so that it meets the specific requirements for Jefferson High School.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

The current Jefferson High School building was originally built in 1909 with multiple modifications and additions occurring throughout the 1960's. Jefferson High School, located in the North Portland Albina neighborhood, is a densely developed site that has historically served as one of the anchors of the Black community in Portland and was historically considered Portland's Black high school. The 14-acre site includes the original 1909 structure, later alterations and additions, track, fields, and parking. Approximately 300,000 SF, the school is bound by North Killingsworth to the North and North Humboldt Street to the South, and is bisected towards the south of the site by North Albina Street.

A Conceptual Master Planning effort was undertaken in late 2019 to help inform cost estimates for inclusion of the Jefferson High School Modernization project on the District's successful 2020 Bond measure. This effort was guided by a Conceptual Master Planning Committee (CMPC) that included parents, teachers, students and community stakeholders.

The Conceptual Master Planning work was guided by several key principles that developed over

the course of early meetings: be a hub with access provided to its community; honor Jefferson's history as Portland's black high school and celebrate its future diversity; create a flexible and adaptable design; provide welcoming, safe, resilient and accessible facilities; offer a rich variety of educational opportunities and maintain strong partner programs; and provide essential outreach and engagement.

Since 2022, the Project Team has guided the project design through several updates as part of Board & District Leadership direction, with the new design reflecting a requirement to keep students on site and construct a new building on the North end of the site.

After the Cost Reduction Study Phase in early 2025, the Project Team developed a revised design that achieved a total project cost savings of $25M. The revised design achieves the PPS Ed Spec required school capacity of 1,700 students with space to support JHS unique programs including new Career Technical Education [CTE] programs, a 720-seat theater, new dance studios for the Jefferson Dancers program, a centrally located student commons, dedicated spaces for local community partners and service providers, a new main gym and auxiliary gym, new football field, track, grandstand, and a multi use baseball/soccer field, plus a softball field, and tennis courts.

FISCAL IMPACT

The total project budget identified in the 2020 Bond materials for the Jefferson High School Modernization project was $311M.

The original budget allocation was established in early 2020, and planning at this point could not have predicted the market disruptions experienced in the intervening years. Two independent cost estimates were obtained in November 2020. Based on these cost estimates and forecast data, the total proposed Comprehensive Plan Budget was $366M.

In December 2023, the PPS Board of Education approved a change to that approach, where students would remain on campus during construction in the existing building, while a new building is constructed on the North end of the site. On April 2, 2023, the Board approved this approach, with a $491M total project cost.

In February 2025, the Project Team was directed to develop a Cost Reduction Study approach that met the framework provided in the Board Resolution No. 7051 to Adopt a Framework to Build High-Quality High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner. The Project Team worked to determine the revised scope and appropriate cost reductions, achieving a total project cost savings of $25M, with a $466M total project cost.

Please see the attached Jefferson HS Comprehensive Plan Report for more detailed project cost information.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

This JHS project has been underpinned with broad and meaningful community engagement founded in the principles of Design Justice.

As the Jefferson High School modernization project moves into the Design Development phase,

community engagement continues to play a central role. The current approach is focused on bringing the broader community into the design process through public information sessions, community workshops, classroom visits, and participation in events like Back to School Night, 8th Grade Information Night, Good in the Hood, and Juneteenth. In this next phase, there is also a renewed focus on engaging students and families from Jefferson's feeder schools, who will be directly impacted by the future of the new campus. These broader efforts are designed to make the process more open, accessible, and transparent as the design evolves.

Earlier phases of the project were shaped by years of smaller, targeted engagement with key stakeholders. Structures such as the Comprehensive Planning Committee (CPC), Design Advisory Group (DAG), and Community Design Organizers (CDOs) provided critical insight during the Conceptual and prior Schematic Design phases. These groups — composed of students, families, alumni, educators, and community partners — helped ground the project in Design Justice principles and brought forward voices often excluded from traditional planning processes. This earlier input generated valuable lessons and clear priorities that continue to guide design decisions today.

To date, the project has included over 150 engagement events — more than any PPS modernization — and collected over 4,500 comments through classroom attendance, school events, advisory groups, surveys, workshops, and community meetings. As the project evolves, these past learnings are being used to shape broader outreach efforts, inviting new and returning participants into the process. By expanding from targeted stakeholder groups to inclusive, community-wide engagement, the design team is ensuring that Jefferson's future reflects the full spectrum of its community's history, needs, and aspirations.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

If the proposed JHS Comprehensive Plan is approved, the Project Team will continue forward with building and site design. This will take place in coordination with ongoing community engagement. Design will continue through the Fall of 2026.

Construction will occur in three phases, with students and staff staying on site. The first phase is targeted to begin in the Spring of 2026 with early field improvements, which will be complete in the Winter of 2026/27. Construction of the new school building will begin at the start of 2027 and continue until the Spring of 2029, with students and staff moving into the building in the Fall of 2029. The final phase will include demolition of the existing building and completion of site work, including the track and football fields, and will be completed by the Fall of 2030.

Please see the attached Comprehensive Plan Report for more detailed project schedule information.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Staff requests approval of the proposed Jefferson High School Revised Comprehensive Plan Resolution.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The new modernized Jefferson High School will provide each student with an equitable, individualized, high-quality learning experience and the tools to reach their full potential within an environment that is safe, healthy, and joyful. The new Jefferson High School will embody PPS's Mission, Vision and Values, and its Climate Policy, to strengthen the future of its students and its communities through a robust set of Guiding Principles that guide the process, the cultural experience, and the school program.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff requests approval of the proposed Jefferson High School Revised Comprehensive Plan Resolution.

ATTACHMENTS

A. Jefferson HS Revised Comprehensive Plan
B. Jefferson HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Board Presentation